

An Introduction to the Entrepreneurial Mindset

Carl Thomas

How Entrepreneurial Are You?

- Feel free to complete the Entrepreneurial Survey to find out how entrepreneurial you are
- Either scan the QR code below or visit www.foundersignals.co
- Use promo code STUDENT for free access
- Takes 5 minutes MAX

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Overview

1. **Introduction**
   Who am I? What is this workshop all about?

2. **What does it mean to be entrepreneurial?**
   Exploring the development of Enterprise Skills

3. **How to spot problems and opportunities**
   Exploring using clean language questions

4. **How to test if a problem could be an opportunity**
   Uncovering the root cause of a problem



Who am I?

- Started my own Internet business as a teeager, and was a commercial manager for O2/ Telefonica
- Founder of an award winning tech startup and Europe’s largest community for Wearable Tech enthusiasts
- Mentor/ Student Enterprise manager for student entrepreneurs
- EIR for Virgin Startups, MSDUK and DOHE



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Who are you?

- 30 second elevator pitch
  - Your name, your course, and a few BRIEF details on your idea



Is Entrepreneurship important?



Is Entrepreneurship important?

- Creating your own opportunities
- Standing out when you graduate
- Enterprise Skills for life

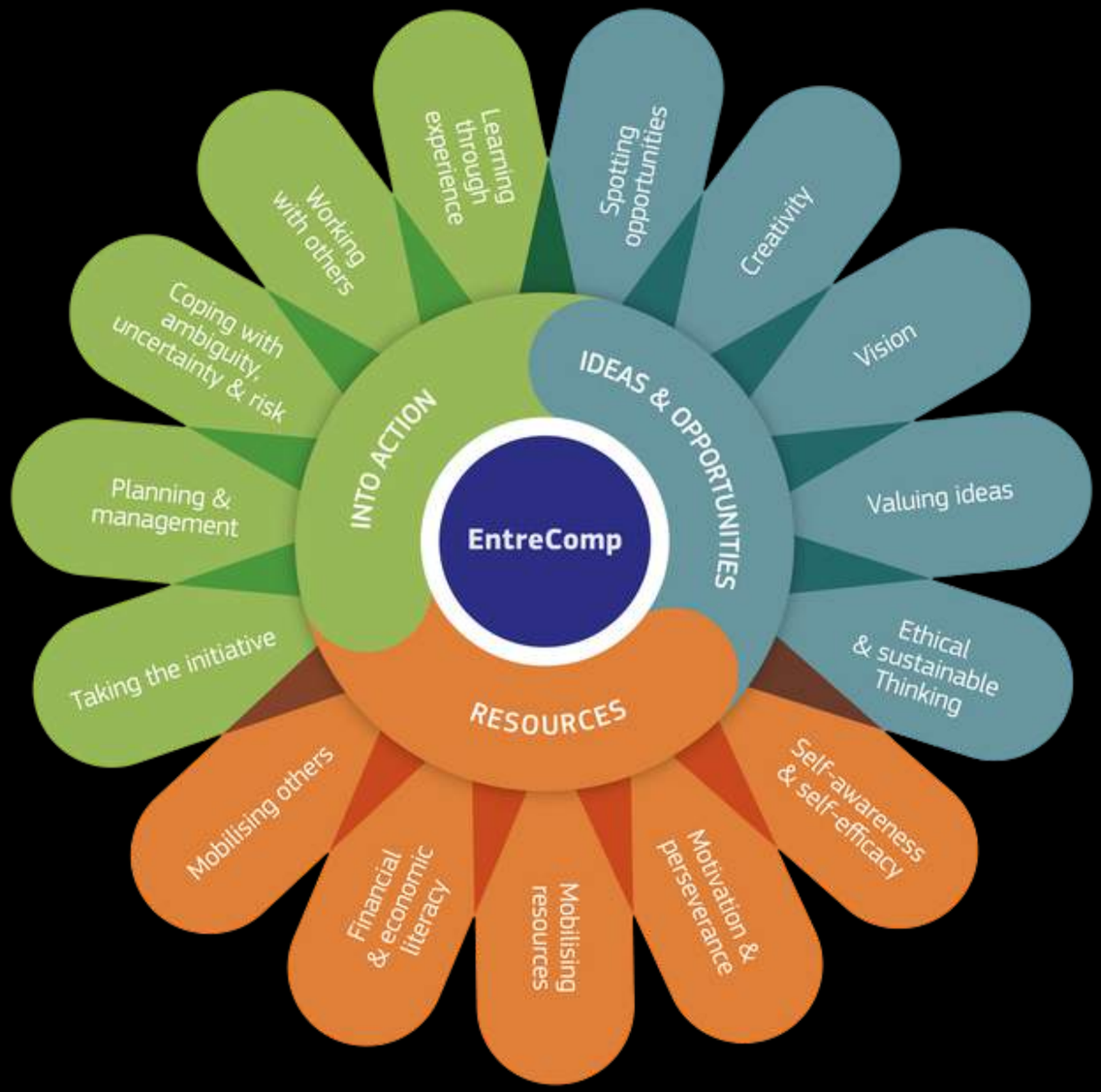


YES!

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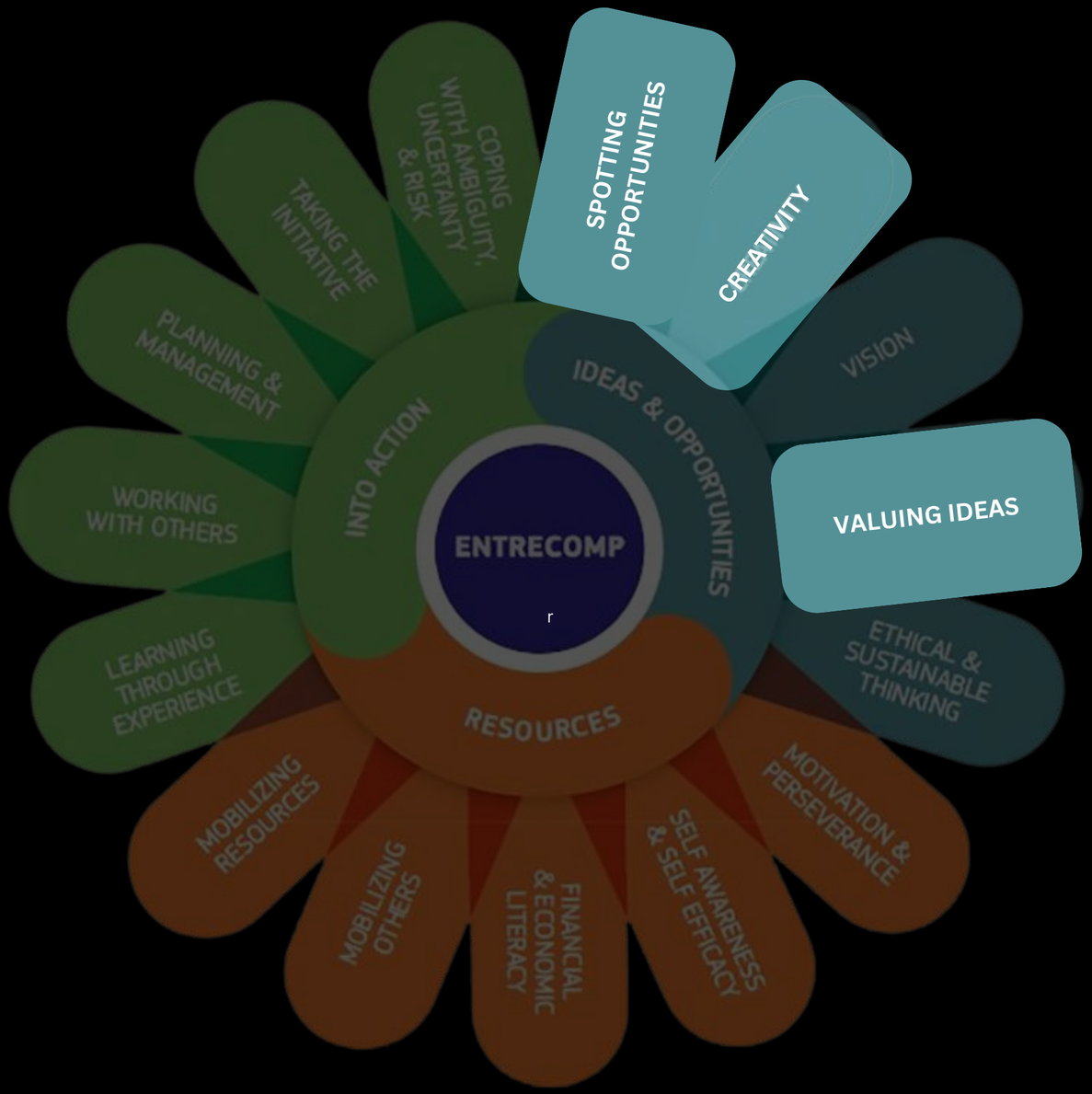
What does it mean to be entrepreneurial?

- Enterprise Skills make someone entrepreneurial
- The Entrecomp framework helps to define these skills so you can develop them
- These same skills also make you employable



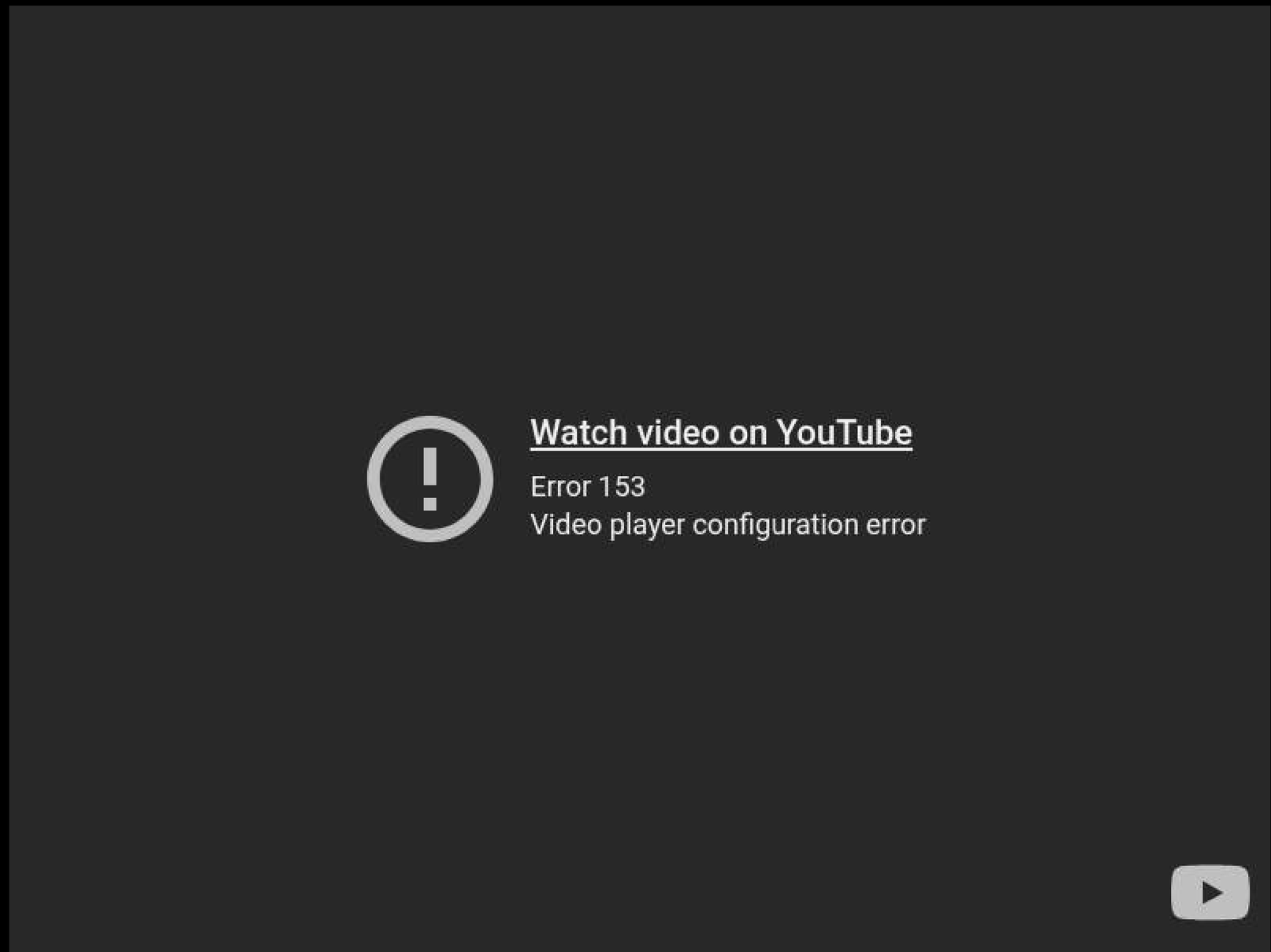
- **Spotting Opportunities**
- **Creativity**
- **Valuing Ideas**
  - Great for - Trend Trackers/ Creative Experimenter
  - Needed for - Operator Athletes/ Force multiplier

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“Tune in, Hook up…”



YouTube Link

“Tune in, Hook up...”

- YouTube started as a dating website that no one used
- They spotted an opportunity to open it up for general use
- Today 500 hours of video are uploaded to YouTube every minute



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Fixing Fast Fashion - Sojo

- After a summer intern @ Depop, Josephine spotted an opportunity
- On demand repair app connecting customers with seamsters
- She’s raised over £2 million and has partnered with brands like Selfridges



How to spot opportunities

Understanding Yourself

- What are your talents?
- What are your interests?
- What are your passions?
- What are your skills?

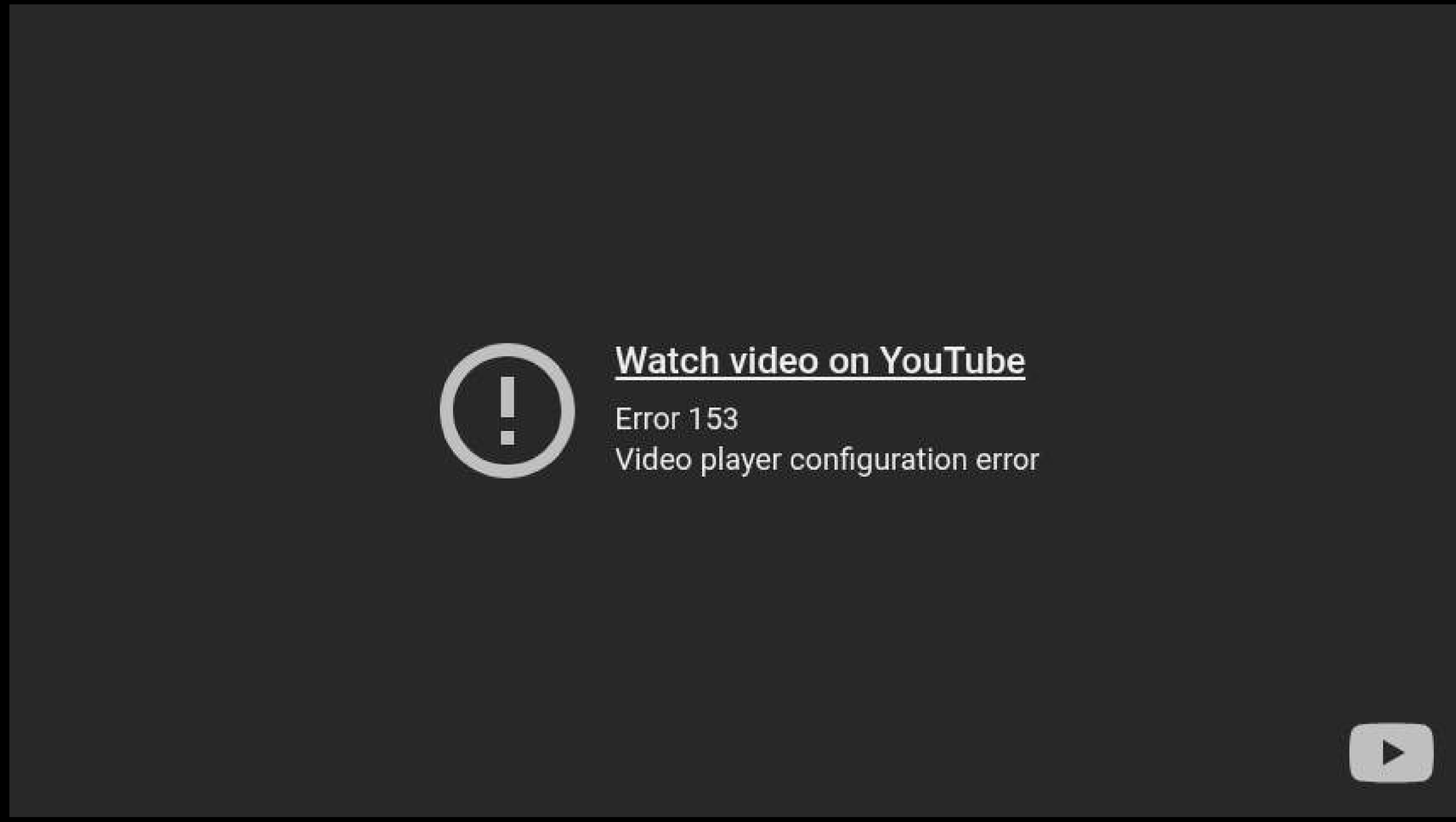
Understanding Others

- What problems exist for others?
- What can someone do something faster/ cheaper?
- What do people want to improve?
- How do people want to be percieved?



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“Design with Empathy”



YouTube Link

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Bumble - Human Centered Design

- Empathise - Understand the Human Experience of dating for women
  - Women felt vulnerable or objectified
  - Women wanted to feel safe, respected and empowered
  - Men were looking for more meaningful connections
- Define and reframe the problem
  - How can we design a dating experience that empowers women to feel in control, feel respected and encourages equality?
- Ideate - Generate ideas to address empowerment and safety



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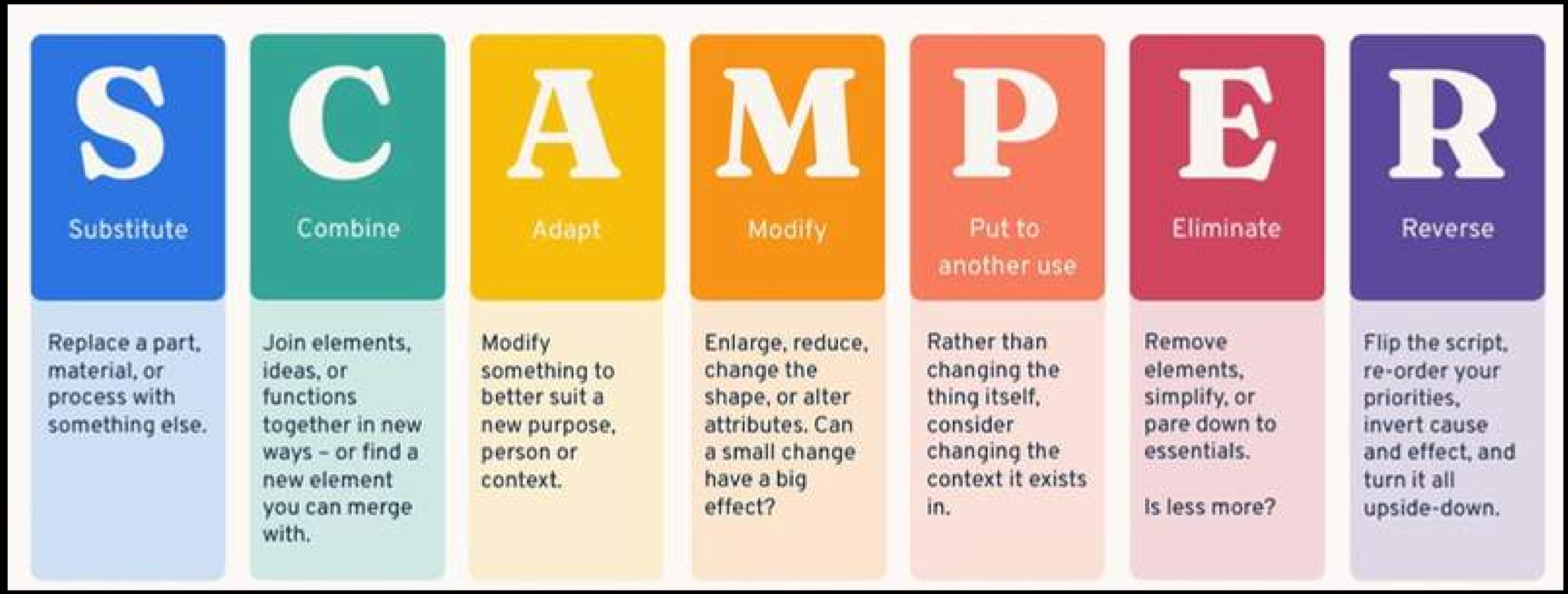
How Bumble re-imagined online dating

- Substitute
  - Replace ‘anyone can message first’ with ‘women make the first move’
- Combine
  - Merge dating and professional networking (Bumble Buzz) and friendships (Bumble BFF) into one app
- Adapt and Eliminate
  - Swipe as many people as possible > Meaningful interactions through conversation starters and prompts.
- Reverse
  - Reverse the power dynamic through focusing on the dating experience for women

“Innovation doesn’t always mean inventing something new. Sometimes it means rethinking what already exists.”



SCAMPER Method



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SCAMPER Sprint Exercise

- Get into groups of 4
- Choose ONE household object per group to focus on
- Within the group, choose 2 SCAMPER prompts (e.g., Substitute, Reverse etc)
- You'll have 10 minutes TOTAL to apply them to your object. Feel free to discuss among your group.
- The goal is to come up with two new versions of the object as possible.
- You'll be sharing your favourite idea back to the group













SCAMPER Sprint Exercise Example

- Substitute: Replace bristles with eco-friendly silicone tips.
- Combine: Merge with a timer or motivational music.
- Adapt: Design for pets or toddlers.
- Modify: Add replaceable heads or foldable design for travel.
- Put to Another Use: Use as a makeup brush cleaner.
- Eliminate: Remove handle and make it a finger glove design.
- Reverse: Toothbrush dispenses toothpaste automatically.



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The best problems are Pills, not Vitamins

- Pill - A must have that solves a painful urgent need
- Vitamin - A nice-to-have that solves something useful
- Entrepreneurs should focus on finding pills



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Can you spot a Pill from a Vitamin?

- Yhangry - A market place for private chefs. For those who host events at home and want reliable chefs
- Piglet in Bed - Sustainable high quality and beautifully designed home textiles brand
- Juicero - The ‘Nespresso of Juicers’, with a monthly subscription for compatible fruit packs



Validating Ideas - exercise 15 minutes

In this exercise, you'll work in groups to break down a problem statement, dig into its root causes, and check if it's a real opportunity worth solving using AI and real-world insights.

Spot → Dig → Test → Judge

"Good entrepreneurs learn to spot problems clearly, test effectively and focus on the ones that matter"



Spot the Opportunity

Break down your problem statement to understand it further

- Who - Who is affected by this problem?
- What - What exactly is the problem?
- When - When does the problem occur?
- How - How do they currently solve the problem?
- Why - Why is this problem important to solve?

For an example, scan the QR code above, or go to https://bit.ly/4mONLnn

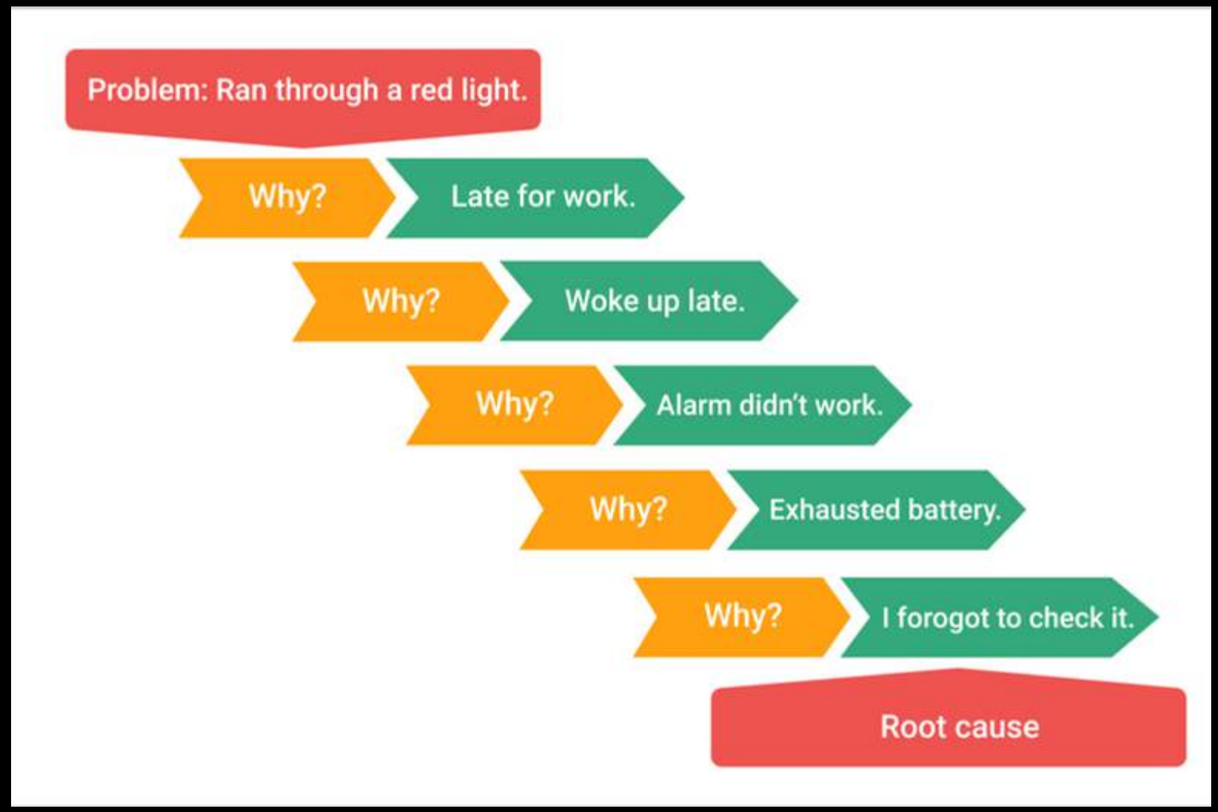


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Dig Deeper

The Five Whys

- A simple but powerful way to look past the surface problem, and dig to the root cause
- Developed at Toyota as part of their manufacturing process
- Problems are often symptoms of something deeper
- The 5 Whys avoid us wasting effort and resources developing the wrong solution for a problem that’s not severe (a pill)
- This process strengthens our problem statements

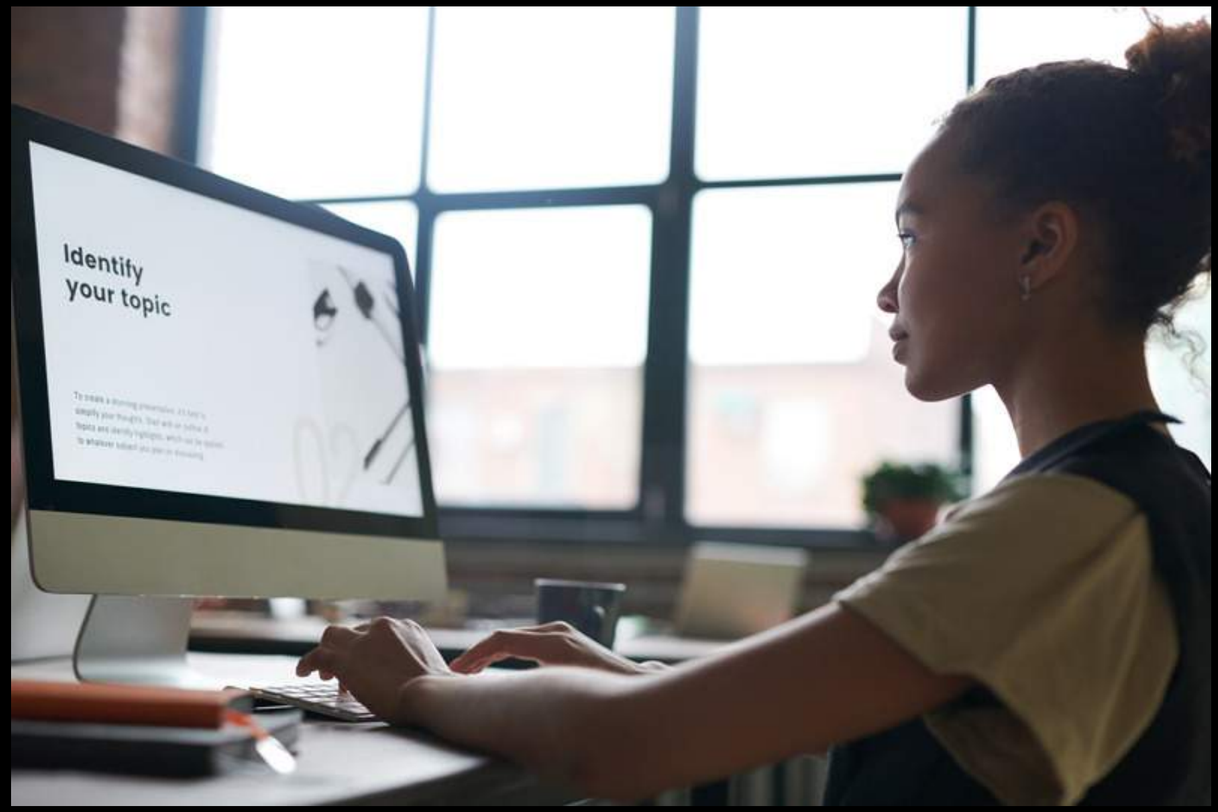


Dig Deeper

Ask “Why does this happen?” five times in a row, to discover the root cause of a problem.

Write down each answer as a chain. Circling the final answer that feels like the root cause.

For an example, scan the QR code above, or go to https://bit.ly/4mONLnn



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Test and Validate with Reddit and AI

Check to see if the problem is real, painful and worth solving

- Scan the QR code or go to bit.ly/MWPFL4 to access the master prompt.
- Copy and paste the ENTIRE prompt into ChatGPT
- Input your problem statement and Step 1 answers
- Compare what the AI shows you with your results from Step 2

“Validation is about listening to real voices, not just our assumptions”



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Judge the results

Compare your assumptions with real voices

- Compare your final Step 2 root cause with the Reddit insights
- Discuss whether they match or are different
- Decide whether this is a pill or a vitamin
- Write a short statement in your group
  - “We believe this problem is a {Pill/ Vitamin} because...”



Key Takeaways

From Assumptions to validation to insights

- Spotting Opportunities is all about validation
- Dig deeper to understand the root cause of a problem
- Test and validate your assumptions
- Pills over Vitamins

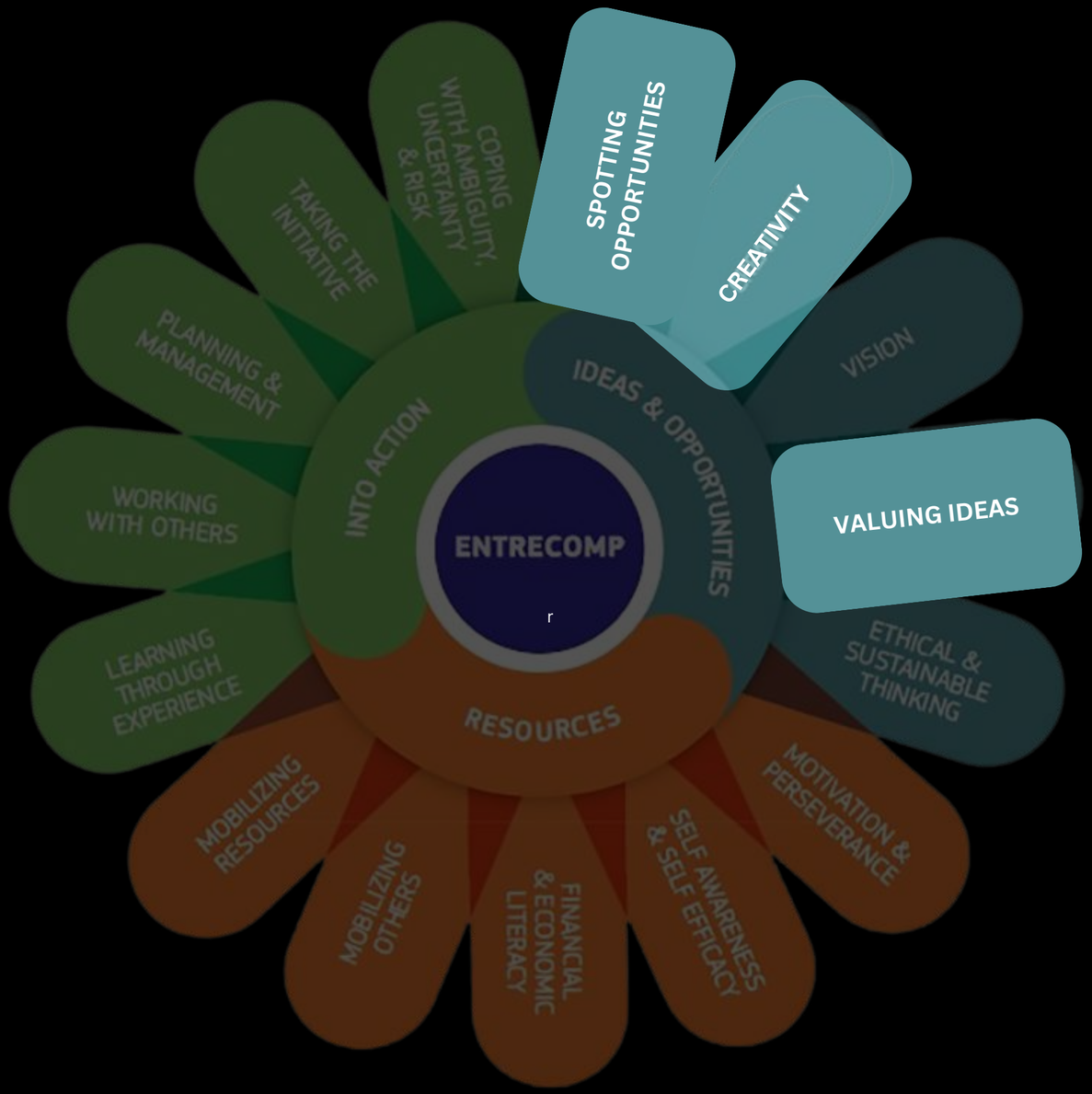
“Entrepreneurs succeed when they learn to spot real problems, test them and focus on solving the ones that matter”



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That’s it!

If you could fill out this short 2 minute survey, it REALLY WOULD be helpful!

- https://bit.ly/CarlFeedback





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